CURRICULUM VITAE

Abu Nayeem Md. Shahidullah, MPH (OHS)

PROFILE SUMMARY

Abu Nayeem Md. Shahidullah is a disaster risk management, emergency response, fire safety, and occupational health and safety specialist with more than 35 years of leadership experience across government, development, humanitarian, and private-sector organisations. As Director General of Bangladesh Fire Service and Civil Defence (2008–2013), he led a workforce of over 6,500 personnel and managed 257 fire stations and training institutions nationwide. He pioneered Bangladesh's first Urban Community Volunteer Programme, training more than 62,000 volunteers under the UNDP-supported Comprehensive Disaster Management Programme (CDMP), significantly strengthening community resilience and disaster preparedness. His expertise spans disaster risk reduction, emergency management, institutional reform, organizational development, climate resilience, occupational safety, business continuity, training systems, and public-private partnerships. He served as advisor UNDP, Save the Children, BRAC, and leading national institutions on organizational strengthening, policy development, and capacity building. Currently, he serves as Advisor of the FBCCI Safety Council, supporting private-sector resilience, emergency preparedness, and workplace safety initiatives.

CORE COMPETENCIES

• Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR)
• Emergency Response & Incident Management
• Fire Safety & Occupational Health and Safety
• Institutional Development & Organizational Reform
• Capacity Building & Training Systems
• Community-Based Disaster Risk Management
• Climate Resilience & Adaptation
• Business Continuity & Emergency Preparedness
• Public-Private Partnerships
• Humanitarian & Civil-Military Coordination

CONSULTANCY EXPERIENCE

National Consultant Save the Children, Bangladesh March 2020 – November 2020 Assignment: Fire Safety and Evacuation Training Manual Development • Reviewed and updated training materials for urban community volunteers. • Integrated community preparedness and evacuation practices. • Strengthened volunteer capacity-building approaches.

National Consultant UNDP Bangladesh October 2019 – December 2019 Assignment: TO&E Reform Initiative, Bangladesh Fire Service and Civil Defence • Conducted institutional assessments and organizational reviews. • Evaluated

operational capacity and structure. • Recommended modernization and performance improvements.

National Consultant UNDP Bangladesh October 2020 – December 2020 Assignment: Organizational Reform Initiative, Bangladesh Fire Service and Civil Defence • Assessed management systems and organizational effectiveness. • Led stakeholder consultations and reform planning. • Developed recommendations to enhance service delivery and emergency response.

National Consultant UNDP Bangladesh January 2024 – June 2024 Assignment: Facilitation of INSARAG (International Search and Rescue Advisory Group) team accreditation process for MoDMR, FSCD.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Advisor, FBCCI Safety Council September 2021 – to date • Leads private-sector safety, resilience, and emergency preparedness initiatives. • Supports business continuity and emergency response planning. • Strengthens collaboration among government, industry, and development partners. • Led the establishment of Private Emergency Response Teams under the Bangladesh Preparedness Partnership (BPP).

Director General (Fire Chief) Bangladesh Fire Service and Civil Defence January 2008 – January 2013 Key Achievements: • Directed Bangladesh's national fire, rescue, and emergency services. • Oversaw development of approximately 300 fire station projects. • Established the Urban Community Volunteer Programme, training over 16,000 volunteers. • Introduced Slum Volunteer and Diver Volunteer initiatives. • Led major disaster response operations and training modernization efforts. • Served as National Operational Focal Point for INSARAG. • Member of the National Disaster Management Advisory Committee and National Platform for Disaster Risk Reduction.

Adviser Disaster, Environment and Climate Change Programme (DECC), BRAC April 2013 – October 2014 • Provided strategic guidance on disaster resilience, climate adaptation, and environmental sustainability. • Supported renewable energy and waste-to-energy initiatives.

Chairman Khulna Development Authority January 2006 – January 2008 • Led urban planning and infrastructure development initiatives with a focus on resilience.

Bangladesh Army May 1977 – January 2006 Retired as Brigadier General. Key Experience: • Disaster response, humanitarian assistance, and emergency logistics. • Civil-military coordination and relief operations. • Instructor, School of Infantry and Tactics. • UN Military Observer, UNIIMOG (Iran-Iraq Mission).

EDUCATION

Master of Public Health (Occupational Health & Safety), Bangladesh University of Health Sciences. Bachelor of Arts (Social Welfare), National University, Bangladesh.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

• Harvard Kennedy School, USA – US-South Asia Leader Engagement Program on Disaster Management (2012)
• Fire Service & Civil Defence – Fire Safety, Rescue and Disaster Management
• UN Civil-Military Coordination eCourse (2017)
• Business Emergency Operations Center Management Course, Philippines (2024)
• National Defense University, China – Crisis Handling and Anti-Terrorism
• College of Combat, India – Crisis Management and Administration
• School of Infantry and Tactics, Pakistan – Security and Disaster Management

SELECTED NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL ENGAGEMENTS

• Global Platform for Disaster Risk Reduction, Geneva • INSARAG Regional Workshops • Regional Emergency Response Planning Meetings • IFCAA General Conference, Japan • International Fire Safety and Rescue Conferences in the USA, Germany, Italy, and Finland • Regional Disaster Risk Reduction and Emergency Response Forums.

PUBLICATIONS AND TECHNICAL CONTRIBUTIONS

• Training Module for Urban Community Volunteers • Articles on fire safety, earthquake preparedness, and occupational safety and health • Case study on garment industry fire incidents • Technical presentations and media contributions on disaster management and emergency response

HONOURS AND AWARDS

• Independence Day Award (2016) • Border Guard Bangladesh Medal • Vocational Excellence Service Award (Rotary Club • Flood and Cyclone Relief Operation Medals • National Election Security Medal